



DIONYSIA

— FOUNDING CREATOR PACK —

For Luc.

— PREPARED, BY HAND, ON THE EVENING OF MAY 14, 2026 —

Luc — the question you asked today, "Who else do you have as a founding member?," is the question only a peer asks. Not a curious onlooker, not a fan, not a creator-in-training — a peer doing the same due diligence on the room he is about to walk into that he would do on any serious collaboration. It is the move that earned you this brief tonight, exactly as promised.

And the line before it — "You're in Toronto? We're in Montreal, not too far away!" — set the tone in one stroke: collegial, geographically casual about something that is in fact strategic. Toronto–Montreal is the spine of English- and French-Canadian cinema running through the same corridor. The founding circle now anchors on both ends of it, with you on the Quebec side. That isn't decoration. It changes what the platform looks like at first light.

What follows is the long-form version of the yes you already gave. Read it the way you'd read a director's bible and a technical spec at once — your two registers are exactly the ones the document was written in. Write back with anything that lands wrong, anything missing, anything you'd change. The room is being built with you in it.

I. WELCOME

DIONYSIA is not another upload feed and it is not a curated showcase that pretends to be a platform. It is the beginning of a permanent institution: a global home for serious cinema made in a new medium, built to outlast a hundred trend cycles and to scale, deliberately, into one of the cultural surfaces this medium will be defined by.

The first chapter is being built with a founding circle of filmmakers whose craft long predates the current AI moment — people who have already built studios, schools, careers, and bodies of work, and who can tell the difference between a generated frame and a directed one. You are one of them. Not as an early user of a product, and not as a name on a launch list. As one of the architects of the institution itself.

Your arc is the rarest profile in the founding circle: twenty-five years inside the machine, as a full-stack engineer, paired with a working filmmaker's eye — co-founding Above The Void as a *boutique* AI cinema studio in Montreal (the noun matters: boutique, not factory; not pipeline-for-volume, but studio-with-a-point-of-view), and now building DreamReel.io as the infrastructure underneath. You can read what is in a frame and you can read what is in the codebase that produced it. That dual literacy is what separates serious cinema in this medium from everything else being made with the same tools, and the founding circle needs it in the room.

Everything DIONYSIA will mean in five years gets shaped by the work this founding circle puts on the wall in this first chapter — and by the standard you, collectively, decide is the standard. This document is the long-form version of your yes. The point isn't to ask you to agree with every word — it's to make sure you know exactly what you are joining, before May 24 makes it real.

II. THE FOUNDING CHARTER

Every platform pretends to have values. Most discover them under pressure and rewrite them quietly. DIONYSIA's charter is fixed, in writing, before the doors open. It is the rail every editorial, product, and infrastructure decision will pass through — at this size, and at every size after.

— WE BELIEVE —

- *that AI is a medium, the way 16mm or DV is a medium — not a subject, not a genre, and never the noun in our sentences.*
- *that the films are directed, not summoned. A tool can render a frame. Only a filmmaker can intend one.*
- *that emotional resonance is the only criterion that matters. Audiences will always forgive imperfect images. They never forgive emotional disconnection.*
- *that a serious work deserves to land in a place where serious people will actually watch it — credits, breath, silence, and all.*
- *that curation is care, not gatekeeping. A "no" with a reason is more respectful than an algorithm's indifference.*
- *that the filmmakers who built the first chapter should be honored as such — economically, editorially, and culturally — for as long as the platform exists.*

— WE REJECT —

- *the contextual collapse of feeds — where a year of work shares a scroll with an "animals dancing" clip and authorship quietly disappears.*
- *the slot machine of unmoderated upload, the cynicism of "creator-owned" as marketing copy without real ownership, and any phrase that uses the word "content" to describe a film.*
- *open submissions without an editorial wall. Submission is not publication.*
- *algorithmic for-you feeds, where popularity becomes a substitute for taste and curation disappears into noise. Discovery on DIONYSIA stays editorially intentional — at this catalog size, and at every size after.*

— any framing — internal or external — that treats founding filmmakers as a stepping stone, a stage, or an audience to be replaced. You are not the rollout. You are the institution.

III. YOUR ROLE

The honest version of what we are asking — and, just as importantly, of what we are not.

— WHAT WE ASK —

1. **ONE FILM, OR MORE, WHEN READY.**

We are inviting you to bring the work you'd want this place to be defined by. That can be a single film, a small curated set from Above The Void's slate, or new work made on a timeline that respects what serious cinema actually takes. We are not chasing volume. We are honoring the standard you and Above The Void already set in Montreal.

2. **PRODUCTION NOTES, WRITTEN BY YOU.**

A short director's statement for each film — what the film is, what it was trying to be, what the tools were, where the hand was, where the machine was. This is not marketing copy. It is the record that lets a viewer take your work seriously. For someone who can speak to both the cinematic intent and the underlying pipeline, this is a register the founding circle especially needs on the wall.

3. **YOUR NAME ON THE FOUNDING WALL.**

A public credit as a founding filmmaker of DIONYSIA, with the right to revoke it at any time. The wall is the most visible asset in the platform's first year, and it belongs to the people who built the first chapter — permanently, regardless of where DIONYSIA goes after. Above The Void's name appears beside yours if you'd like.

4. **PRESENCE, ON TWO NIGHTS.**

The Founding Filmmakers night — gated, private, peer-to-peer — and a single public premiere window in the weeks after, where you appear in the live room with viewers for thirty to forty-five minutes. Both are detailed in Section V.

5. **HONESTY, IN PRIVATE.**

Tell us what is broken. Tell us what is missing. Tell us when the editorial framing is wrong about your work — and tell us when the platform itself is making a technical decision you'd make differently. The founding circle is a peerage, not a customer base. With your engineering depth, that second register matters as much as the first.

— WHAT WE DO NOT ASK —

1. **NO EXCLUSIVITY REQUIRED.**

At this stage, no exclusivity is asked of you, on any film. Above The Void's work can keep distributing wherever you already place it. As the platform matures, opt-in premiere-window agreements with clear, transparent terms will be introduced — never as a default condition, and never tied to founding-circle status. The regulations that govern licensing, windowing, and rights will be written carefully and shared in writing before they take effect.

2. **NO VOLUME TARGETS, NO UPLOAD CADENCE.**

We will never ask you to ship faster. The founding circle exists in the opposite direction from those incentives. If you bring one film or you bring several, both are welcomed on the terms you set.

3. **NO MARKETING LABOR.**

You are not a growth channel for the platform. We will not ask you to repost, cross-promote, tag, or perform on social. If you choose to share through Above The Void's channels or DreamReel.io's, that is yours.

4. **NO SILENCE IN EXCHANGE.**

If at any point this stops being a place you want your work in, you tell us, we lift the films, and you leave with everything you came with. The door swings both ways, at every size the platform reaches.

IV. SUBMISSION SPECIFICATIONS

The platform runs on a premium video pipeline (Mux), the same infrastructure used by MasterClass, Patreon, and HBO Max. The specs below will read as familiar — they are, deliberately, the language a twenty-five-year full-stack engineer running a cinema studio already speaks.

- **MASTER FORMAT** ProRes 422 HQ, DNxHR HQ, or high-bitrate H.264 / H.265 .mp4. Any high-quality master is fine; we transcode from there.
- **RESOLUTION** 1920×1080 minimum; 3840×2160 (4K) preferred where it exists. Vertical orientations supported but framed for letterbox display by default.
- **FRAME RATE** Native to your project — 23.976, 24, 25, or 29.97 fps. Do not conform unnecessarily.
- **AUDIO** Stereo or 5.1, 48 kHz, -14 LUFS integrated target (broadcast-streaming standard). Loudness pass strongly preferred; we can normalize if needed.
- **RUNTIME** No upper or lower bound. Shorts (under 15 minutes), features, episodic — the editorial frame adapts. We resist the dogma that any one runtime is "right" for the medium.
- **POSTER** A title-card still at 800×1200 (vertical) plus a 1920×1080 hero frame. If you don't have a poster, we'll cut one from the film with you.
- **CAPTIONS** .vtt or .srt — English required (machine-generated draft is fine, your final approval). French as a second track if you'd like, given Quebec.
- **PROVENANCE** Tools used, hand-authored layers, AI-generated layers, and — if any synthesized likeness appears — performer-consent attestation. Part of the public film record. A moat, not a footnote.
- **DELIVERY** Direct link to a private cloud transfer (Frame.io, Dropbox, Google Drive, WeTransfer Pro). No public file hosts. Receipt confirmed in writing inside twenty-four hours.

These specifications are the current pipeline. The platform's video, audio, and rendering quality will continue to improve with every update — and masters delivered into the founding library today automatically inherit every upgrade after. The standard floor will only rise. Yours rises with it.

If any of the above is a problem — gear constraints, formats from the Above The Void side, anything — write back. The specs are a target, not a wall.

V. THE TWO NIGHTS

The first chapter has two scheduled moments. Both are deliberately curated. Both are non-negotiable as cinema events — they happen with you, or they do not happen.

— THE FIRST NIGHT —

Founding Filmmakers, Sunday, May 24, 2026.

Private, gated, peer-only. The platform opens for the first time, with the founding filmmakers and the founder in the room. Magic-link sign-in, allowlist-only — no public URL works, no link forwards, no spillover. The work on the walls that night is yours and the others'. Your films *are* the catalog.

No press, no metrics, no audience-facing spectacle. The point of the first night is that the people who built the institution are the first to see it standing up.

— THE SECOND NIGHT —

DIONYSIA First Light, June 8–10, 2026 (one evening, date confirmed by June 1).

On the evening of June 8–10, we'll open the doors a little wider — for one night only. Film experts, curators, fellow artists, and the people you'd want in the room are invited to a live premiere of the founding work. You'll be the host, not the visitor. More on that closer to the date.

Live comment surface (Discord, Telegram, or Substack — locked by June 1). One founding film unveiled in full. The filmmaker present in the live room for thirty to forty-five minutes after the credits roll. Format borrowed from MUBI's "Film of the Night" and the indie album-release listening party, sharpened for cinema.

Your role on the second night is not to perform. It is to be in the room while serious people watch your work for the first time, and to answer the questions that follow with the same care you put into making it.

Toronto and Montreal are on the same clock and the same train line. Both nights run on Eastern time — no logistics friction, no time-zone gymnastics. If the second night ends up worth marking in person, that conversation is on the table too.

VI. A DIRECT LINE

There is no support queue. There is no founding-creator portal. There is one person running this, and that person is reachable.

For anything substantive — film delivery, the editorial framing of your work, the second-night logistics, a doubt about the institution, an idea that should change the platform, or a technical note about anything under the hood — write to kanishtuteja@gmail.com directly. Replies inside twenty-four hours, usually faster.

The platform itself lives at dionysia.ca. Until May 24 it shows a single opening surface — the one you've already seen. On the first night, the room behind it opens, and your allowlisted email gets you in.

If something is wrong, say it directly. The founding circle is small enough — and serious enough — that there is no professional reason to soften the signal. You're not a customer. You're a peer.

VII. CLOSING

The cultural surfaces that defined the last century of cinema — the studios, the festivals, the houses — all began with a founding circle of artists who took the work seriously before anyone was watching.

DIONYSIA is being built to be one of those surfaces for the medium that comes next: to be everywhere this work deserves to be seen, on every screen it deserves to live on, for as long as cinema is made this way. The institution begins with you in it.

The reel is hand-set, frame by frame. Thank you for the standard you brought to the conversation today.

— ONE LAST WORD, JUST FOR YOU —

Luc, the arc from twenty-five years inside the codebase to co-founding Above The Void to building DreamReel.io is the exact through-line DIONYSIA is built to honor: a filmmaker who is also, structurally, the kind of person who builds the infrastructure the next era of cinema actually runs on. Most filmmakers in this medium are operators of tools they don't understand the inside of. You are not most filmmakers. The founding circle needs that voice in the room, and the rest of the world's serious AI filmmakers will see it on the wall.

Montreal is one of the cities the first chapter of this medium has to run through, and the Toronto–Montreal axis is now the Canadian spine of the founding circle. Having you on the Quebec end of it is not symbolic. It changes the geography of what DIONYSIA's opening looks like — and what every founder coming after you reads when they see who else is already in the room.

Whatever the work you'd want this place to be defined by — bring it. Whatever needs to flex around Above The Void's calendar, DreamReel's roadmap, or the way you and your co-founder actually run the studio — say it. The room is being built with that conversation already in mind.

Welcome in.

— *Kanish*

FOUNDER, DIONYSIA
DIONYSIA.CA